Calm-Touch Pulse – measurement method

How we measure the effect of the sessions · October 2026

Calm-Touch Pulse shows what state employees are in when they arrive at a session, how much a 15–20-minute Calm-Touch session improves it, and how their mental load develops from month to month. The company receives a short, group-level report every month – never individual results.

Why we measure

A common weakness of workplace wellbeing programmes is that their effect is judged on impressions alone. Calm-Touch Pulse replaces this with a short self-assessment built on scientific measurement tools.

The report answers three questions for the company:

- **What state are employees in right now?** The level of tension, calm and tiredness on arrival (State pulse).
- **Does the intervention work?** How much the state improves during a session (Effect).
- **Is anything changing in the long run?** How workload, the ability to switch off and exhaustion develop month by month (Monthly trend).

The measurement also fits the practice of managing psychosocial risks: it provides regular, documented feedback on the effect of a preventive measure.

How it works

The measurement consists of two short questionnaires completed on a phone; participants open them with the QR code displayed on site.

	Snapshot	Monthly questionnaire
When	before and after every session	once a month, after the first session of the month
Content	6 questions on the current state; afterwards 3 short closing questions	11 statements about the past month + 1 open question
Time needed	about 30 seconds per session	about 2 minutes
Scale	1 = not at all … 10 = completely	1 = not true of me … 10 = completely true

Participants enter a four-digit code of their own choosing. It pairs the before and after answers and ensures that the monthly questionnaire is completed only once a month; we do not ask for names or e-mail addresses. Participation is voluntary and requires explicit consent. The questionnaires are available in Hungarian, English and German.

The questions and their scientific background

The questions were compiled for Calm-Touch: each one is based on the construct of an internationally researched, validated measurement tool, in a shortened, single-item form. Numbers in square brackets refer to the references at the end of this document.

Snapshot ("Right now…")

#	Question	What it measures	Scientific background
1	How tense do you feel right now?	tension	Thayer's tension–calmness dimension [1]; single-item stress measurement [2], [3]
2	How calm do you feel right now?	calm	Thayer's calmness scale [1]
3	How much are your thoughts racing right now?	mental restlessness	the "troubled mind" element of the single-item stress symptom question [2]
4	How mentally tired do you feel right now?	mental tiredness	Thayer's energy–tiredness dimension [1]
5	How fresh and energetic do you feel right now?	energy	Thayer's energy scale [1]
6	How much tension do you feel around your head, shoulders or arms right now?	physical tension in the treated area	visual analogue scale-based self-rating [3]

After the session there are three closing questions: how safe and comfortable the participant felt; how likely they are to recommend it to a colleague (0–10, following the Net Promoter method [10]); and one word that comes to mind.

Monthly questionnaire ("In the past month…")

#	Statement	What it measures	Scientific background
1	I often felt that too many things were piling up on me at once.	mental load	Perceived Stress Scale [4]
2	During the day I was easily able to switch off for short periods.	switching off	psychological detachment from work [5]
3	At the end of the working day I felt mentally exhausted.	exhaustion	Copenhagen Burnout Inventory [6]; need for recovery [7]
4	I was able to take conscious breaks during my working day.	recovery	recovery experiences: relaxation, control [5]
5	In the hours after Calm-Touch I felt calmer.	immediate effect	effects of single-session touch interventions [11]
6	After Calm-Touch I found it easier to concentrate on my tasks.	focus	programme-specific evaluation item
7	The sessions helped me notice tension in my body more.	body awareness	interoceptive awareness (MAIA) [8]
8	I feel that my workplace cares about my wellbeing.	caring culture	perceived organisational support [9]

#	Statement	What it measures	Scientific background
9	The timing and organisation of the sessions fitted well with my work.	organisation	programme-specific evaluation item
10	I would like Calm-Touch to be available regularly.	wish to continue	programme-specific evaluation item
11	I feel my current workload is sustainable in the long term.	sustainability	need for recovery and burnout research [6], [7]

The questionnaire ends with an open question: what was best about the sessions, and what would you change.

Indicators and colour ratings

All values in the report fall between 1 and 10, and **10 is always the best state**. For negatively worded questions (tension, racing thoughts, tiredness, physical tension, workload, exhaustion) scoring is reversed: a participant who marks 8 for tension receives 3 points for freedom from tension.

Indicator	What it shows	Green	Amber	Red
State pulse	wellbeing on arrival: average of the 6 snapshot questions before the session	above 6	4.1–6	4 or below
Effect	how much wellbeing improves during a session (after – before)	at least +2	+1 to +1.9	below +1
Monthly trend	monthly wellbeing: average of workload, switching off, exhaustion, recovery and sustainability	above 6.5	4.6–6.5	4.5 or below

Additional indicators: share of participants who improved, session rating, comfort and recommendation score (between −100 and +100).

The State pulse thresholds follow the risk band described for a 0–10 workplace stress scale: there, a stress value above 5 calls for closer attention and around 7 and above for intervention [14]. The other thresholds are initial values. We fine-tune them using the data from the first three months.

Data protection and anonymity

The company receives group-level summaries only; no individual employee's answers can be identified.

- **No name, no e-mail.** Participants are identified only by a four-digit code they choose themselves, which the company does not know.
- **At least 5 people.** Team-level results are shown only when they are based on answers from at least 5 people. Data from smaller groups appear only in the company-wide summary.
- **Voluntary.** Completing the questionnaire is not a condition of participation and requires explicit consent.
- **Secure storage.** Data are recorded on a server within the European Union over an encrypted connection.
- **Data controller:** Alternatíva Tanácsadó Csoport Kft. Details can be found in the privacy notice.

What it is and isn't suitable for

Calm-Touch Pulse is designed to track the effect of the programme and to signal how employees are doing; it is not a diagnostic tool.

- **Suitable** for making the group's state, the immediate effect of the sessions and the direction of monthly change visible.
- **Not suitable** for assessing an individual's condition, diagnosing burnout or anxiety, or evaluating employees' performance.
- **Does not replace** the legally required psychosocial risk assessment; it can be a complementary data source for it [15].
- The results are based on voluntary self-report, so they are influenced by who responds and by current circumstances. Without a control group, monthly change cannot be attributed solely to the programme.

If a team's State pulse stays red over several sessions, we flag it and recommend a targeted assessment or a stress management workshop.

Calm-Touch is a workplace wellbeing service, not a medical treatment, and does not replace medical or psychological care.

References

The conceptual basis of the questions [1]–[10], the research background of the touch- and ASMR-based intervention [11]–[13], the thresholds [14], and the workplace framework [15]–[16].

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